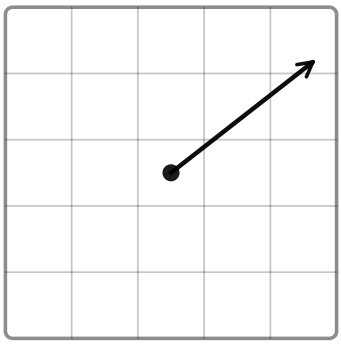
Problem Framing Canvas

Bounded problem definition with user impact and business context



AT A GLANCE

5–15 people · 45–60 min · intermediate

WS-01

Problem Framing Canvas

RUN IT

1. Bound the work: problem, not features or specs.
2. Each person notes one observable friction silently.
3. Map frictions to revenue, churn, or support load.
4. Cluster duplicates, then draft three problem statements and choose the one the room defends.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Solution jumping: the statement names the fix the room already wanted, so the session debates a tool.

THE FIX

Strip the tool out. Ask what in the workflow costs measurable time or money, then rewrite without a product.

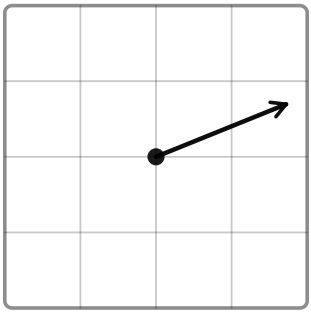
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

Widely used in design practice; no single documented originator.

How Might We (HMW)

Standardized opportunity statements ready for divergence



AT A GLANCE

1–15+ people · 15–30 min · beginner

WS-02

How Might We (HMW)

RUN IT

1. Explain How, Might, We: a path exists, failure is permitted, ownership is shared; ban solutions.
2. Post the validated pain points, then each person drafts two to four ten-word questions per point.
3. Cluster identical intents without speaking, moving other people's notes that belong together.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Questions come out so broad they give no grip, or so narrow they hide a chosen feature inside the question.

THE FIX

Ask what the user is deciding at that moment, then rewrite around that decision with one concrete constraint.

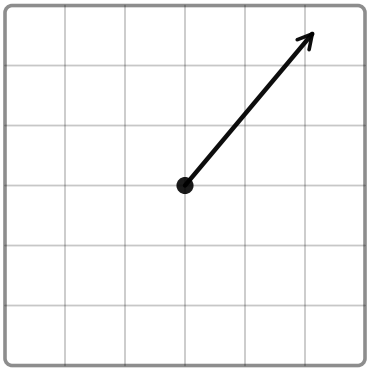
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

Widely used in design thinking practice; no single documented originator.

5 Whys Root Cause Analysis

Uncovered underlying structural failures rather than symptoms



AT A GLANCE

1–10 people · 20–30 min · intermediate

WS-03

5 Whys Root Cause Analysis

RUN IT

1. Write the symptom as a fact: what happened, when, how many, and for how long it lasted.
2. Ask why five times, recording the direct enabling condition, never a person's lapse.
3. Keep one necessary chain and stop at a policy or architecture choice this team can change.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

The chain ends at a name or splits into rival trees, so the room leaves with blame or a diagram, not a fix.

THE FIX

Say the person was the trigger, not the cause; ask what safeguard was missing and follow that path.

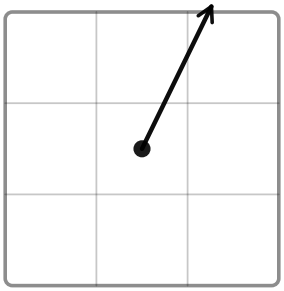
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

Developed by Sakichi Toyoda and used at Toyota; no single canonical publication.

Sailboat Retrospective

Categorized operational anchors, wind, goals, and hidden rocks



AT A GLANCE

3–15 people · 30–45 min · beginner

WS-04

Sailboat Retrospective

RUN IT

1. Draw the boat, island, wind, anchors, and reefs; say what each one means for this team.
2. Give eight silent minutes: at least two winds, two anchors, and one reef per person.
3. Group notes by similarity, stack duplicates to show weight, then name two anchors to cut.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Anchors arrive as vague complaints and the room spends most of the hour on forces it cannot move.

THE FIX

Ask which specific handoff broke and what was missing from it, then park company-level items at the perimeter.

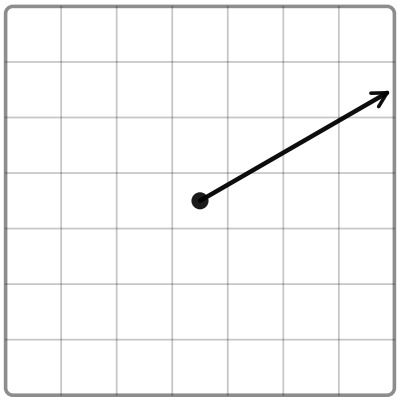
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

A common agile retrospective metaphor; no single documented originator.

Pre-Mortem Analysis

Comprehensive catalog of catastrophic risks and preventative controls



AT A GLANCE

5–15 people · 45–60 min · advanced

WS-05

Pre-Mortem Analysis

RUN IT

1. Treat the failed launch as settled history.
2. Give six silent minutes to write the causal chain.
3. Read every failure aloud, no defense allowed.
4. Vote for failures both likely and fatal, keep the top three, then name the gate to build.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Owners defend the plan as each risk is read, so the room rehearses reassurance instead of failure.

THE FIX

Say the failure already happened, then ask what collapsed despite the controls and name the risk people avoid.

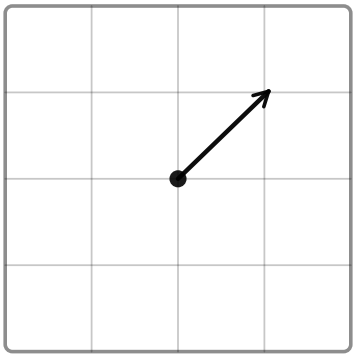
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

Source: Gary Klein (2007). *Performing a Project Premortem.* Harvard Business Review.

Hopes and Fears

Calibrated baseline expectations and surfaced emotional hazards



AT A GLANCE

5–15+ people · 20–30 min · beginner

WS-06

Hopes and Fears

RUN IT

1. Draw Hopes and Fears columns, two note colors.
2. Ask each person to write one specific hope and one specific fear about this work, in silence.
3. Post and read both columns aloud, group the themes, then agree one action for the biggest fear.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Fears soften into vague worries and hopes into cheerleading, so the board names no real hazard.

THE FIX

Ask what would have to happen for that fear to come true this quarter, and write the answer on the card.

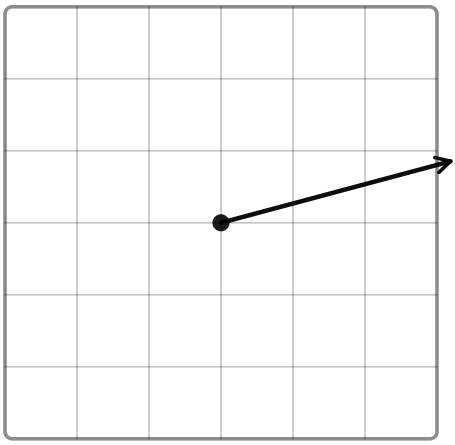
PROVENANCE

Steps written for this deck from the method's public definition; the source has no protocol.

A common workshop and agile team warm-up; no single documented originator.

User Journey Mapping

End-to-end temporal visualization of user touchpoints and pain points



AT A GLANCE

3–10 people · 60–90 min · intermediate

WS-07

User Journey Mapping

RUN IT

1. Agree persona, goal, start, and end first.
2. Lay out stages in time order as columns, naming each from the user's point of view.
3. Mark pain points and drop-offs, then circle the two transitions this team should fix first.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

The map lists internal process steps in company language, documenting the organization, not the user.

THE FIX

Ask what the user would say they were doing; if it is an internal handoff, rewrite the visible user moment.

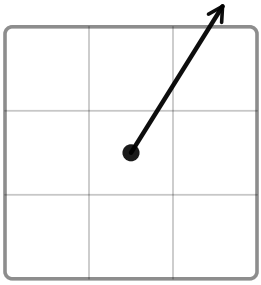
PROVENANCE

Steps written for this deck from the method's public definition; the source has no protocol.

A standard service design and UX method; no single documented originator.

Empathy Mapping

Synthesized user observations across Says, Thinks, Does, and Feels



AT A GLANCE

3–10 people · 30–45 min · beginner

WS-08

Empathy Mapping

RUN IT

1. Draw Says, Thinks, Does, Feels for one real user.
2. Fill Says and Does first from observed quotes and actions, not from assumptions.
3. Infer Thinks and Feels from those observations, mark each guess, then name the tension.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

The team fills all four quadrants from memory, so Thinks and Feels become invented inner monologue.

THE FIX

Ask for the quote or action behind each note; if absent, park it in a to-verify corner outside synthesis.

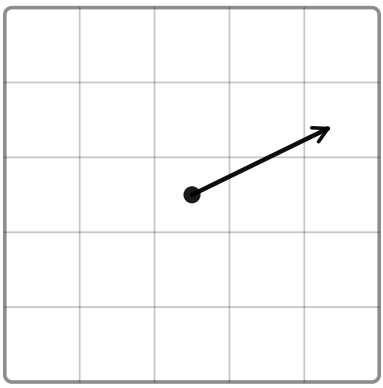
PROVENANCE

Steps written for this deck from the method's public definition; the source has no protocol.

Widely used in design practice; no single documented originator.

Problem Tree Analysis

Hierarchical root-cause, core challenge, and downstream effect tree



AT A GLANCE

5–15 people · 45–60 min · intermediate

WS-09

Problem Tree Analysis

RUN IT

1. Write the core problem on the trunk in one sentence, with no cause or solution in it.
2. Ask why, and place root causes two levels deep.
3. Place consequences above as branches, then circle the roots this team can influence.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

The tree becomes a wish list: causes and effects share a level, and the trunk is a vague label.

THE FIX

Sort each note as a reason below or an effect above, then rewrite the trunk with an actor and a cost.

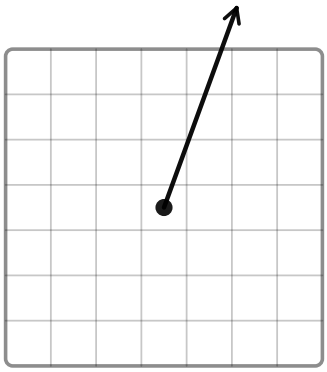
PROVENANCE

Steps written for this deck from the method's public definition; the source has no protocol.

Used in development and policy analysis; no single documented originator.

Lightning Decision Jam (Framing)

Rapid identification and re-framing of key operational blockers



AT A GLANCE

3–10 people · 30–40 min · beginner

WS-10

Lightning Decision Jam (Framing)

RUN IT

1. Set the timer and have everyone silently write the blockers they hit, one per note.
2. Dot-vote the blockers and keep the top three.
3. Reframe each kept blocker as a How Might We, then vote and carry the best reframe forward.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

The room votes on blockers but never reframes them, so the session ends with the same complaints.

THE FIX

Take the top blocker, ask what opportunity hides in it, and make the room solve that question instead.

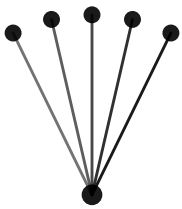
PROVENANCE

Steps written for this deck from the method's public definition; the source has no protocol.

Developed by AJ&Smart as a rapid workshop format; no single canonical publication.

Crazy Eights

Rapid individual generation of eight distinct interface or concept riffs



AT A GLANCE

1–15+ people · 10–15 min · beginner

WS-11

Crazy Eights

RUN IT

1. Fold each sheet into eight boxes and state the rule: sixty seconds per box, no exceptions.
2. State the challenge once, start the clock, and call each box aloud so the room keeps pace.
3. At box five, name the fatigue and demand a different mechanism: zero-UI, automated, inverted.
4. Call the final box, stop everyone on time, and collect the sheets without discussing them.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

One polished box and seven blanks: the clock stops driving.

THE FIX

Say: crude boxes are the point; move on unfinished, now.

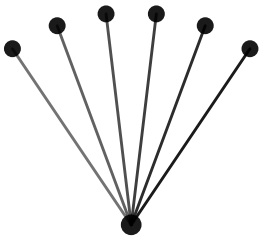
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

Source: Jake Knapp (2016). *Sprint.*

Reverse Brainstorming

High-volume generation of ways to intentionally cause failure



AT A GLANCE

5–15 people · 30–45 min · intermediate

WS-12

Reverse Brainstorming

RUN IT

1. Reframe it as sabotage: how do we guarantee failure?
2. Give eight minutes: red notes, one failure tactic each.
3. Cluster red notes by failure vector, then name each.
4. Turn each cluster into a green mechanism, not a denial.
5. Pair each green note with its red cluster; read the best.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Half-working looks like a wall of red notes and a thin green column: the room enjoyed failure and stopped.

THE FIX

Sabotage is over: one green mechanism per red cluster.

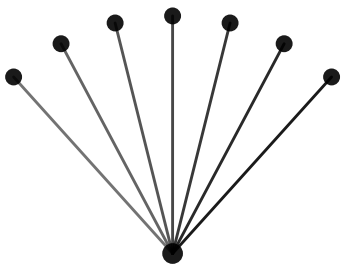
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

A reversal technique long used in creativity training; no origin given in the source.

Round Robin Brainstorming

Sequentially built, peer-iterated solution concepts



AT A GLANCE

5–12 people · 25–40 min · intermediate

WS-13

Round Robin Brainstorming

RUN IT

1. Seat a circle; rule: sketch, pass left, build, harden.
2. Seed zone one with a concept, a headline, and a sketch.
3. Pass left; add to zone two and never erase or judge.
4. Pass left; name zone three's biggest failure and patch it.
5. Return each sheet to its originator and read the chain.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Half-working looks like zone two full of objections: the chain stops evolving and each sheet becomes opinions.

THE FIX

Say: treat the seed as given, then answer yes-and.

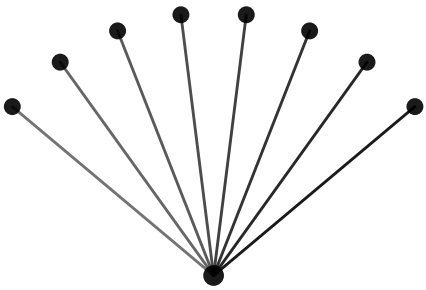
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

A long-standing group technique for chained iteration; no origin given in the source.

Mash-up / Cross-Pollination

Unconventional combinations of disparate technologies or business models



AT A GLANCE

3–15 people · 30–45 min · intermediate

WS-14

Mash-up / Cross-Pollination

RUN IT

1. State the premise: ideas recombine proven mechanisms.
2. Name each outside product's mechanism, not its brand.
3. Force one mechanism against your customer problem.
4. Draft three mash-ups naming the borrowed mechanism.
5. Present each as a transfer; name the behavior change.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Half-working looks like concepts that borrow the logo and nothing else: a theme, not a mechanism.

THE FIX

Ask what behavior it changes, then make that the concept.

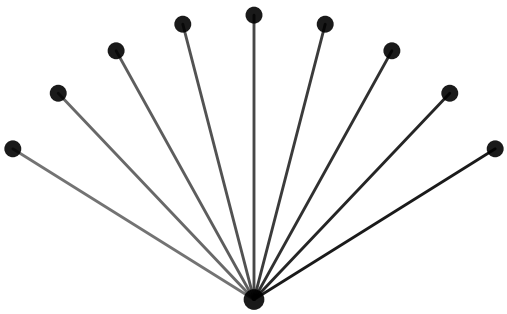
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

Cross-pollination is a common creativity heuristic; no origin given in the source.

Solution Sketching (4-Step)

High-density, self-explanatory three-panel conceptual wireframes



AT A GLANCE

3–15 people · 60–90 min · advanced

WS-15

Solution Sketching (4-Step)

RUN IT

1. Run four timed beats: gather, ideate, riff, then sketch.
2. Review framing and research silently, taking notes only.
3. Diagram flows, then riff the strongest idea eight times.
4. Finish with a three-panel storyboard a stranger follows.
5. Hang the anonymous sketches for a silent read.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Half-working looks like arrows and empty boxes only the author can narrate: the idea dies.

THE FIX

Ask whether a stranger could follow the sketch without you, then add headlines and labels until they can.

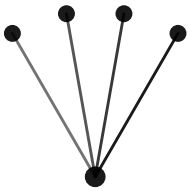
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

Source: Jake Knapp (2016). *Sprint.*

Brainwriting 6-3-5

108 structured ideas generated silently across six team members



AT A GLANCE

6 people · 30–45 min · intermediate

WS-16

Brainwriting 6-3-5

RUN IT

1. Seat six people with a three-column, five-row sheet, and restate the question on the board.
2. For five silent minutes, have each person write three ideas in the first column.
3. Pass right; add three ideas in the next column for five rounds, then count and cluster.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Half-working looks like columns of restatements: people copy the idea above and change one word.

THE FIX

Before each pass, require a different part of the question or a new mechanism, not a rewording.

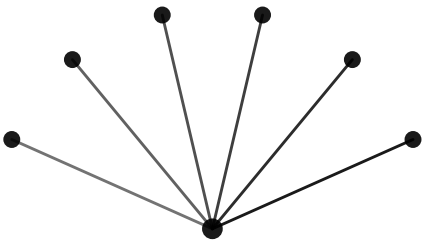
PROVENANCE

Steps written for this deck from the method's public definition; the source has no protocol.

A structured brainwriting format; no origin given in the source.

SCAMPER Ideation

Systematic transformation of existing concepts using seven vectors



AT A GLANCE

3–10 people · 45–60 min · advanced

WS-17

SCAMPER Ideation

RUN IT

1. Put the concept up; name seven prompts: substitute, combine, adapt, modify, repurpose, eliminate, reverse.
2. Work one prompt at a time, asking what changes if that verb were mandatory, and write one variant.
3. Group the variants by prompt, then keep the ones worth developing and record each prompt.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Half-working looks like ordinary ideas with a verb written beside each: the prompts decorate the output.

THE FIX

Pick one prompt and force it: state exactly what changes.

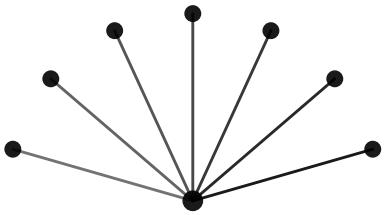
PROVENANCE

Steps written for this deck from the method's public definition; the source has no protocol.

A seven-prompt creativity checklist used in ideation workshops; no origin given in the source.

Worst Possible Idea

De-inhibited concept space built by surfacing terrible alternatives



AT A GLANCE

3–15 people · 20–30 min · beginner

WS-18

Worst Possible Idea

RUN IT

1. Set the challenge, then invert it: ask for the worst possible way to handle it, the more useless the better.
2. Give a short timed round for terrible ideas without defense, then read them aloud and let the room laugh.
3. For each bad idea, name the requirement it insults, write the flip, and keep only what survives.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Half-working looks like a comedy set that ends in laughter: the bad ideas are never mined.

THE FIX

Name the need each joke insults, then write the flip.

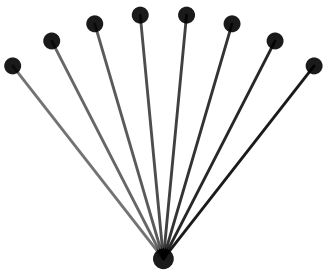
PROVENANCE

Steps written for this deck from the method's public definition; the source has no protocol.

A warm-up used in ideation workshops; no origin given in the source.

Analogous Inspiration

Structural transfer of mechanisms from unrelated industrial domains



AT A GLANCE

5–15 people · 30–45 min · intermediate

WS-19

Analogous Inspiration

RUN IT

1. Name the problem as a function, such as routing or matching, and strip your industry's vocabulary.
2. Find how unrelated domains solve that function and extract each mechanism in one sentence.
3. Map each mechanism onto your problem, write the transfer, and mark what needs evidence.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Half-working looks like a mood board of other industries: the examples are admired, nothing transfers.

THE FIX

Ask what it does structurally, then how we would copy it.

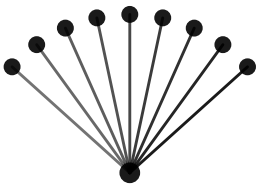
PROVENANCE

Steps written for this deck from the method's public definition; the source has no protocol.

A standard design-research technique; no origin given in the source.

Speed Boat Ideation

Visual discovery of operational drag factors and mechanical engines



AT A GLANCE

3–12 people · 25–40 min · beginner

WS-20

Speed Boat Ideation

RUN IT

1. Draw a boat labeled with the product or team, a destination, and an empty sea around it.
2. Have people add anchors for what slows progress and engines for what speeds it, then explain one of each.
3. Cluster and rank the anchors, turn the top ones into owned commitments, and name the engines to protect.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Half-working looks like a decorated boat with dozens of anchors and no ranking: no decision is made.

THE FIX

Ask for the two anchors that cost the most progress this month, and assign each one an owner.

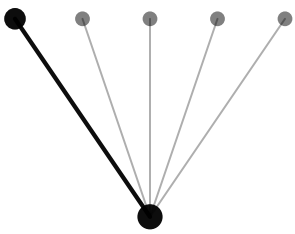
PROVENANCE

Steps written for this deck from the method's public definition; the source has no protocol.

A visual retrospective format; no origin given in the source.

Impact vs. Effort Matrix

2x2 prioritization of quick wins, major projects, and time sinks



AT A GLANCE

3–15 people · 30–45 min · beginner

WS-21

Impact vs. Effort Matrix

RUN IT

1. Draw the impact and effort axes and define both ends.
2. Place items against one agreed baseline, impact first.
3. Shift by real effort, not coding hours alone.
4. Push every card off the center line.
5. Read each quadrant and name its action.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Effort optimism and pet-feature impact inflate every card until the grid crowds one corner and ranks nothing.

THE FIX

Ask what the item costs beyond coding hours, compare it with a known small change, and order the top three.

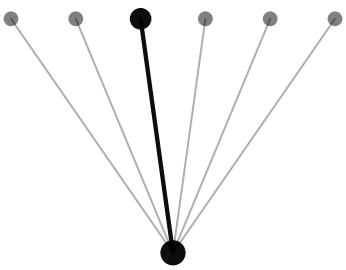
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

Widely used in product prioritization; no single documented originator.

MoSCoW Prioritization

Categorization into Must-have, Should-have, Could-have, Won't-have



AT A GLANCE

3–15 people · 30–45 min · beginner

WS-22

MoSCoW Prioritization

RUN IT

1. Mark four lanes: Must, Should, Could, and Won't.
2. Define Must: no release without it, no workaround.
3. Demote any card that has a workaround.
4. Cap Must near sixty percent of capacity.
5. Read Won't back and name what would reopen it.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Must-have inflation: most cards land in Must, the capacity buffer vanishes, and the release date becomes fiction.

THE FIX

Ask for the workaround. If one exists, demote the card and show the sixty percent cap.

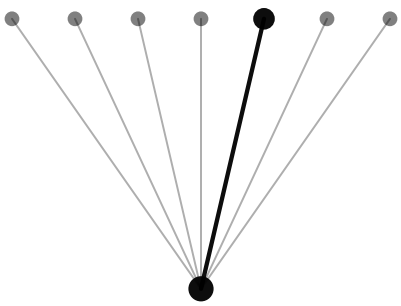
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

Source: Dai Clegg (1994).

Dot Voting / Heatmapping

Visual distribution of group attention across ideas without groupthink



AT A GLANCE

3–15+ people · 10–20 min · beginner

WS-23

Dot Voting / Heatmapping

RUN IT

1. Give each person five dots for the ideas.
2. Choose privately before anyone reaches the wall.
3. Walk the wall silently and place dots without comment.
4. Circle the three densest clusters, not the loudest.
5. Let each cluster's author explain the mechanism.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Bandwagon voting: waiting for leadership, people pile on, so heat measures hierarchy.

THE FIX

Stop the wall, have everyone write choices on paper first, and hide cursors and counts until the timer ends.

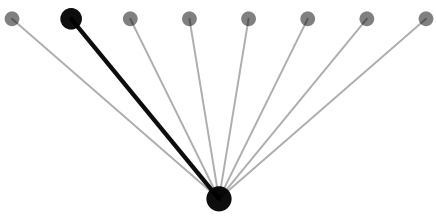
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

Widely used in facilitation practice; no single documented originator.

$100 Allocation Test

Capital-constrained prioritization surfacing true value trade-offs



AT A GLANCE

3–12 people · 20–35 min · intermediate

WS-24

$100 Allocation Test

RUN IT

1. Give each person one hundred dollars to spend.
2. Require whole dollars so every choice costs another.
3. Invest silently and independently, then hand in sheets.
4. Total the sheets and mark consensus and solo bets.
5. Discuss the outliers and the shared zeros.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Peanut-buttering: the budget splits evenly across every item, so no trade-off is made and nothing is ranked.

THE FIX

Reject a flat allocation and require one zero plus forty dollars on a single item; ask what that choice reveals.

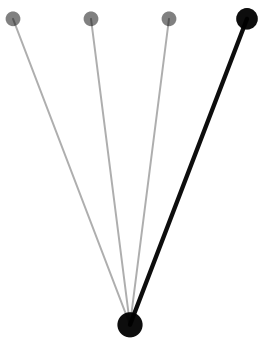
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

Widely used in participatory budgeting; no single documented originator.

2x2 Trade-off Grids

Flexible comparative evaluation across two arbitrary orthogonal axes



AT A GLANCE

3–12 people · 30–45 min · intermediate

WS-25

2x2 Trade-off Grids

RUN IT

1. Name the axes; check one does not imply the other.
2. Label both ends plainly and post them for the room.
3. Place candidates by arguing each axis in turn.
4. Rename the quadrants and name each one's action.
5. Pick one high-risk, high-value bet and name its test.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Correlated axes flatten the grid into a diagonal, every candidate looks alike, and the session decides nothing.

THE FIX

Test whether high on one axis forces high on the other. If it does, replace the axis with a pressure that truly conflicts.

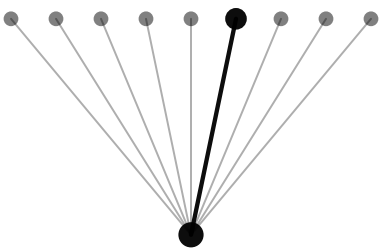
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

Widely used in strategy and design practice; no single documented originator.

Fist to Five Consensus

Rapid non-binary consensus calibration and identification of dissent



AT A GLANCE

3–15+ people · 10–15 min · beginner

WS-26

Fist to Five Consensus

RUN IT

1. Explain the scale from fist-block to five-support.
2. State the proposal, then allow a silent moment.
3. Reveal together and read the lowest hand.
4. Ask what single change would raise it to three.
5. Re-vote once, then record the decision.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

The room chases unanimity, spending the session lifting threes to fives while a real blocker goes unheard.

THE FIX

Say consensus means no blocking dissent, not equal enthusiasm. Ask the lowest hand what would move it.

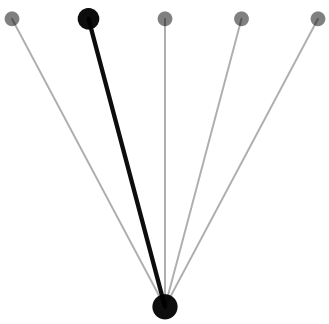
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

Widely used in consent-based decision practice; no single documented originator.

Now-How-Wow Matrix

Idea classification across feasibility (Now), breakthrough (How), and original (Wow)



AT A GLANCE

3–15 people · 25–40 min · intermediate

WS-27

Now-How-Wow Matrix

RUN IT

1. Post Now, How, and Wow columns and define each.
2. Read every idea aloud once without debate, then sort each by feasibility and breakthrough.
3. Choose one Now to schedule, one How to test, and one Wow to prototype, each with an owner.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Everything drifts into Wow, the room celebrates novelty, and no idea gets a route, a test, or an owner.

THE FIX

Ask what the idea would take to run next week. Without an answer it stays in How until a named experiment exists.

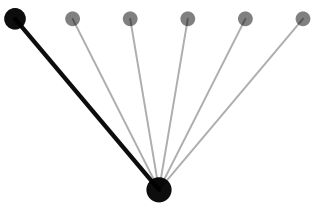
PROVENANCE

Steps written for this deck from the method's public definition; the source has no protocol.

Widely used in innovation workshops; no single documented originator.

Decider Super-Vote

Executive decision lock-in combining democratic heatmaps with authority



AT A GLANCE

5–12 people · 15–25 min · intermediate

WS-28

Decider Super-Vote

RUN IT

1. Show the shortlist and give everyone ordinary votes.
2. Let people vote silently, then cluster the dots and read the heat back to the room.
3. Give the decider fixed supervotes, then record the decision, the owner, and the next checkpoint.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

The vote becomes a poll: the decider abstains, the loudest cluster wins, and the group leaves with no owner.

THE FIX

Hand the decider the supervotes and ask for one sentence of rationale. The vote informs, the decider decides.

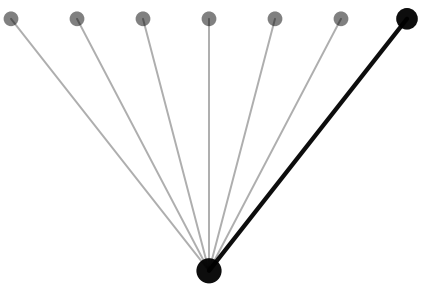
PROVENANCE

Steps written for this deck from the method's public definition; the source has no protocol.

Source: Jake Knapp (2016). *Sprint.* Simon & Schuster.

Trade-off Sliders

Hard ranking of competing technical attributes to eliminate ambiguity



AT A GLANCE

3–10 people · 20–30 min · advanced

WS-29

Trade-off Sliders

RUN IT

1. List attributes that genuinely trade against each other.
2. Draw a slider for each attribute with named ends, and mark the current position as baseline.
3. Move the sliders per candidate to show what each choice sacrifices, then rank by accepted sacrifices.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Every slider drifts to the midpoint, producing a polite ranking that hides each sacrifice and decides nothing.

THE FIX

Ask which end each candidate must give up. If none can name a sacrifice, it was not compared.

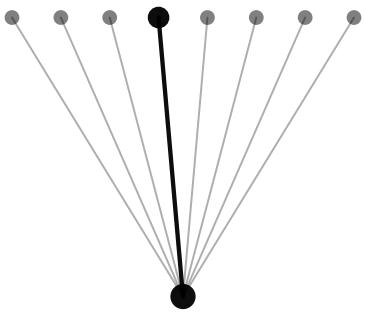
PROVENANCE

Steps written for this deck from the method's public definition; the source has no protocol.

Widely used in product trade-off workshops; no single documented originator.

Nu/Steer/Zweck Framework

Strategic validation against organizational mandate and execution utility



AT A GLANCE

5–15 people · 30–45 min · advanced

WS-30

Nu/Steer/Zweck Framework

RUN IT

1. Write three questions: now, steering, and purpose.
2. Record facts under Nu, then the lever and metric under Steer.
3. State the purpose under Zweck and park candidates that do not line up.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Purpose is recited as a slogan while now-facts and levers stay vague, so every candidate passes.

THE FIX

Ask what would change if the purpose were different; if nothing would, the purpose is decoration.

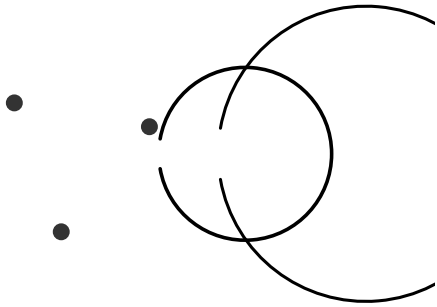
PROVENANCE

Steps written for this deck from the method's public definition; the source has no protocol.

Used in Dutch design-led strategy practice; no single documented originator.

1-2-4-All

Progressive silent reflection, paired synthesis, quartet convergence



AT A GLANCE

4–15+ people · 12–15 min · beginner

WS-31

1-2-4-All

RUN IT

1. Pose one question worth the room's attention, then give everyone a minute of silent writing.
2. Give pairs two minutes to agree on one point.
3. Have fours spend four minutes finding one pattern.
4. Harvest only themes the room has not heard yet.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

The silent minute becomes chatter, the loudest voice frames the pair, and the plenary repeats itself.

THE FIX

Restart the timer and say the first minute is solo; early talk lets the quickest voice set the frame.

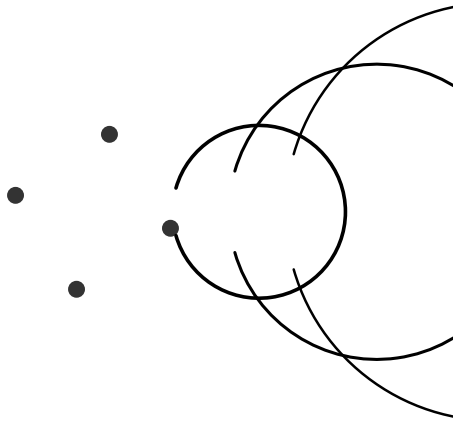
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

Source: Henri Lipmanowicz & Keith McCandless (2014). *The Surprising Power of Liberating Structures.*

Impromptu Networking

Three rapid rounds of paired micro-interviews establishing shared context



AT A GLANCE

6–15+ people · 15–20 min · beginner

WS-32

Impromptu Networking

RUN IT

1. Ask two questions: the challenge you bring and the asset you offer this group.
2. Pair outside your team; chime at two minutes.
3. Re-answer both questions with a new partner.
4. Run round three with one more partner.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

One partner talks through most of the round, so the other gets a rushed answer and the room learns half its assets.

THE FIX

Stop on the chime and model the handoff: if you are mid-sentence, stop; your partner's time starts now.

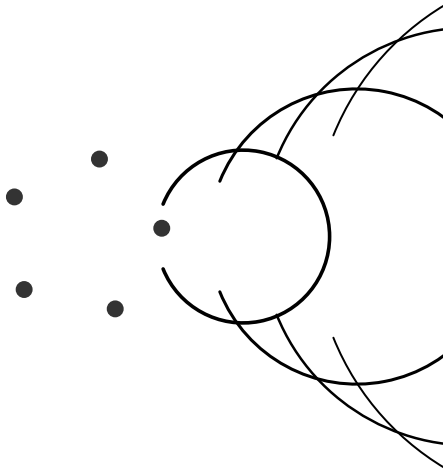
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

Source: Henri Lipmanowicz & Keith McCandless (2014). *The Surprising Power of Liberating Structures.*

TRIZ (Creative Destruction)

Systematic cessation of self-sabotaging behaviors and counter-productive habits



AT A GLANCE

5–15+ people · 35–50 min · intermediate

WS-33

TRIZ (Creative Destruction)

RUN IT

1. Invert the goal: ask the room to design the worst possible system, one that guarantees failure.
2. Draft alone, then build one ruinous list per table.
3. Circle every item we already do, even slightly.
4. Stop the worst habit; name an owner and a date.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

The audit protects feelings, so the room lists habits that describe someone else's organization.

THE FIX

Circle an obvious item yourself and ask the room: what else are we pretending we do not do?

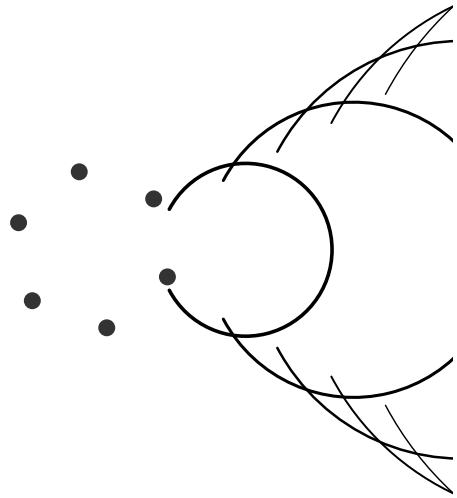
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

TRIZ originates with Genrich Altshuller; this creative-destruction version is the Liberating Structures adaptation.

Troika Consulting

Rapid triad peer consulting using back-turned active listening protocols



AT A GLANCE

3–15+ people · 30–45 min · intermediate

WS-34

Troika Consulting

RUN IT

1. Form triads; the client states the challenge.
2. Consultants ask facts only; hold all advice.
3. Client turns their back while the consultants discuss for five minutes.
4. Client names what landed, then one next step; rotate.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

The client turns around to defend decisions, so consultants manage reactions instead of exploring the problem.

THE FIX

Tell the client: turn back and stay silent; every word you add narrows what they will say.

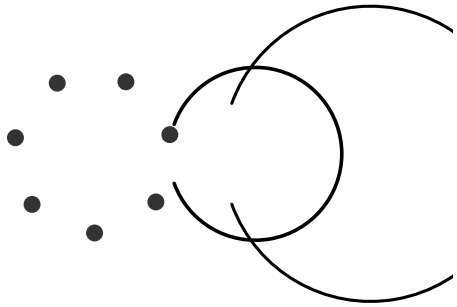
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

Source: Henri Lipmanowicz & Keith McCandless (2014). *The Surprising Power of Liberating Structures.*

25/10 Crowd Sourcing

High-velocity anonymous card exchange scoring boldest breakthrough ideas



AT A GLANCE

15+ people · 20–30 min · intermediate

WS-35

25/10 Crowd Sourcing

RUN IT

1. Each person writes a bold action for the bottleneck and its first step on an unsigned card.
2. Draw five scoring rows, one per shuffle round.
3. Run five blind rounds, scoring each card 1 to 5.
4. Count from 25 down, reading the top-scoring cards.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Scorers cluster on safe threes, so every card lands near 15 and bold ideas look merely polite.

THE FIX

Say a three is a refusal to judge; score a platitude one, brave and actionable ideas five.

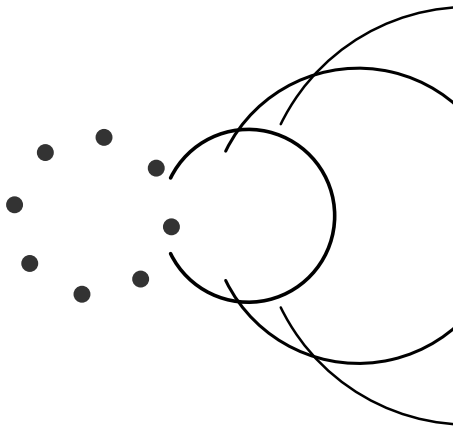
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

Source: Henri Lipmanowicz & Keith McCandless (2014). *The Surprising Power of Liberating Structures.*

Min Specs

Ruthless reduction of operating protocols down to non-negotiable rules



AT A GLANCE

4–15 people · 40–50 min · advanced

WS-36

Min Specs

RUN IT

1. State the purpose, then list every rule and habit the group treats as required.
2. Split the list into musts and shoulds; test each must by what breaking it would cost.
3. Publish the rules that survive; cut the rest.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Every rule has a defender, so the list stays long and the group leaves with a tidier bureaucracy.

THE FIX

Hold up one rule and ask what exactly would fail if we broke it tomorrow; cut what no one can name.

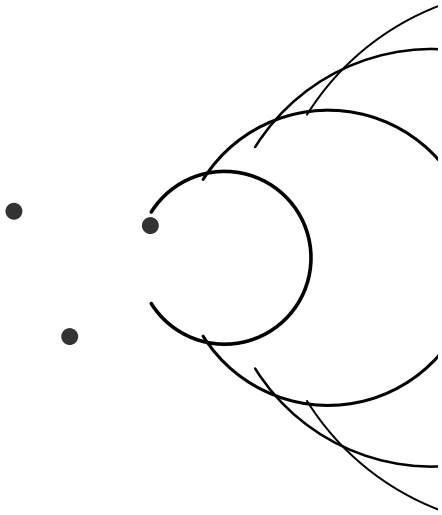
PROVENANCE

Steps written for this deck from the method's public definition; the source has no protocol.

Source: Henri Lipmanowicz & Keith McCandless (2014). *The Surprising Power of Liberating Structures.*

Nine Whys

Progressive conversational excavation of intrinsic organizational purpose



AT A GLANCE

2–15 people · 20–35 min · intermediate

WS-37

Nine Whys

RUN IT

1. Pair people; one describes a project they care about and why it matters to them.
2. Ask 'Why does that matter?' of each answer, following the chain through nine whys.
3. Switch roles and state the purpose you reached.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

The partner accepts a general answer like 'because it matters,' and the chain stalls at a slogan.

THE FIX

Ask once more: 'Why does that matter to you, specifically?' Then wait out the silence before moving on.

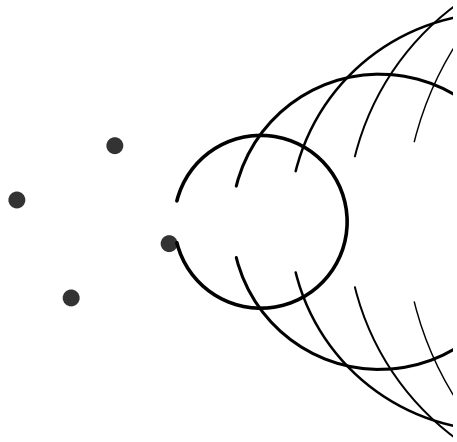
PROVENANCE

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Source: Henri Lipmanowicz & Keith McCandless (2014). *The Surprising Power of Liberating Structures.*

Conversation Café

Structured four-round dialogue suppressing cross-talk on contentious issues



AT A GLANCE

5–12 people · 45–60 min · beginner

WS-38

Conversation Café

RUN IT

1. Name one contentious question; set four rounds with a talking object in the center.
2. For three rounds, only the object holder speaks; no replies or side talk.
3. Open round four; ask what shifted your view.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Cross-talk creeps in, two people debate, and the quiet members stop speaking before the later rounds.

THE FIX

Hold up the object and say no replies yet; we are here to understand, not to win this round.

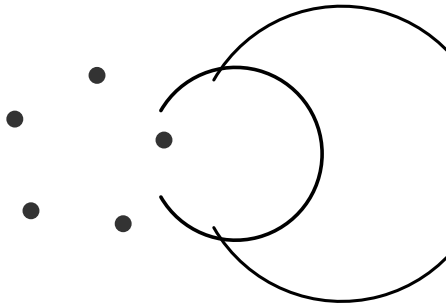
PROVENANCE

Steps written for this deck from the method's public definition; the source has no protocol.

Source: Henri Lipmanowicz & Keith McCandless (2014). *The Surprising Power of Liberating Structures.*

Wise Crowds

Scaled peer advisory council consulting for individual challenge clients



AT A GLANCE

6–15+ people · 45–60 min · advanced

WS-39

Wise Crowds

RUN IT

1. Seat one client before a circle; the client describes the challenge and what they have tried.
2. Advisors ask clarifying questions, then discuss the problem with each other while the client listens.
3. Have the client name what landed; then rotate.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Advisors slip into asking the client what to do, and the circle becomes an ordinary meeting.

THE FIX

Tell the advisors to talk to each other; the client only writes until their final turn comes.

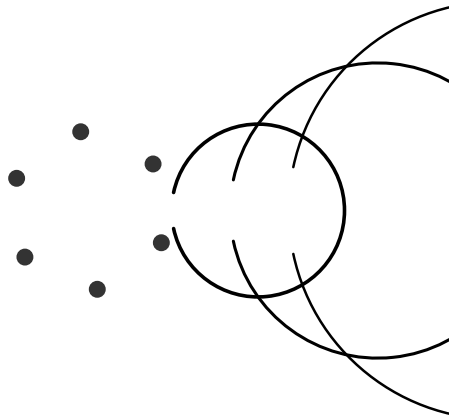
PROVENANCE

Steps written for this deck from the method's public definition; the source has no protocol.

Source: Henri Lipmanowicz & Keith McCandless (2014). *The Surprising Power of Liberating Structures.*

What, So What, Now What?

Ladder of inference progression: observations, interpretations, actions



AT A GLANCE

3–15+ people · 30–45 min · beginner

WS-40

What, So What, Now What?

RUN IT

1. List only what happened, one observation per note, with no interpretation or judgment.
2. Ask what patterns the observations carry, and record the different readings side by side.
3. Name next actions, owners, and a check-in date.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

The room jumps to opinions and fixes, so the group argues about interpretations without agreeing on facts.

THE FIX

Point at the observations and ask what we actually saw before anyone explains it; facts first.

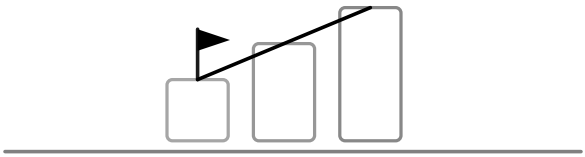
PROVENANCE

Steps written for this deck from the method's public definition; the source has no protocol.

Source: Henri Lipmanowicz & Keith McCandless (2014). *The Surprising Power of Liberating Structures.*

Who-What-When Matrix

Linear operational assignment of accountable owners and hard deadlines



AT A GLANCE

3–15 people · 20–30 min · beginner

WS-41

Who-What-When Matrix

RUN IT

1. State the rules: each task is a visible artifact, each owner a named person, each date a calendar date.
2. List the priority decisions as rows, one task per row, and name the single owner and exact due date.
3. Read the matrix back and confirm each owner has the authority and time to meet that date.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Shared ownership: a row goes to two names, so nobody feels the commitment when the date arrives.

THE FIX

At that row, name one driver, call the other a contributor, and replace any soft date with a real one.

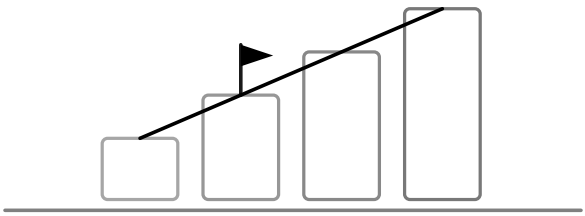
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

A matrix format widely used in project management; no single documented originator.

Next Steps Commitment Canvas

Explicit contractual agreement covering resources, cadence, and sign-offs



AT A GLANCE

3–10 people · 30–45 min · intermediate

WS-42

Next Steps Commitment Canvas

RUN IT

1. Frame the canvas as a charter the room signs today.
2. Fill scope, resources, review cadence, and the risks that could break the whole commitment.
3. Write done as a check that can pass or fail.
4. Read it back, have each member sign, and publish it.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Hidden starvation: the team signs an ambitious scope while every hour is already promised elsewhere.

THE FIX

Before signing, ask what each person will drop to make room; if nothing is named, cut the scope.

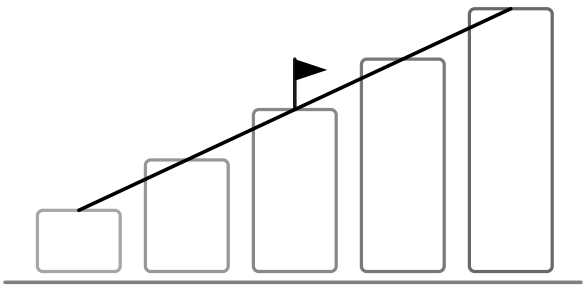
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

A workshop charter format in wide use; no single documented originator.

Lean Canvas Experiment Matrix

Translation of assumptions into falsifiable hypotheses and metrics



AT A GLANCE

3–10 people · 45–60 min · advanced

WS-43

Lean Canvas Experiment Matrix

RUN IT

1. Turn each feature on the canvas into an assumption.
2. Write the riskiest as a falsifiable hypothesis.
3. Pick the cheapest test that could prove it wrong.
4. Set the metric and the number before the test runs.
5. Name the decision a failing result will trigger.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Post-hoc rationalization: with no threshold, any number arrives as support for the preferred idea.

THE FIX

Ask for both numbers now: what rate proves the case, and what rate kills it? Write them down first.

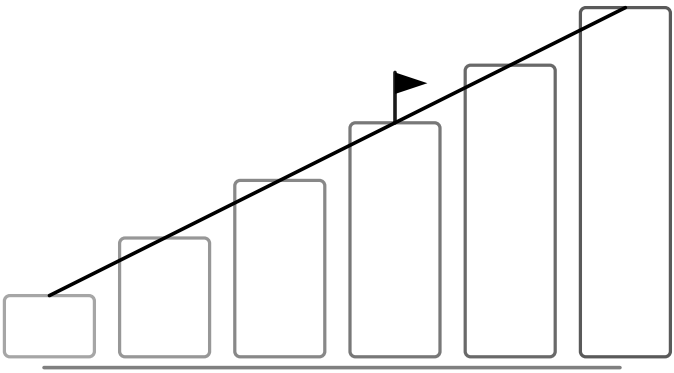
PROVENANCE

Source protocol: the steps follow the written script in the source.

Source: Ash Maurya. *Running Lean.*

15% Solutions

Immediate identification of autonomous individual actions requiring no budget



AT A GLANCE

1–15+ people · 15–25 min · beginner

WS-44

15% Solutions

RUN IT

1. Ask each person what 15 percent they can do now with the authority and resources they hold.
2. Have everyone write one action in silence that needs no budget, permission, or anyone's decision.
3. Share in pairs, then name your first step and help.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

The group drifts into the 85 percent: everyone lists what leadership must change, not their own move.

THE FIX

Park the blockers on a separate list, then ask again what each person can do this week without them.

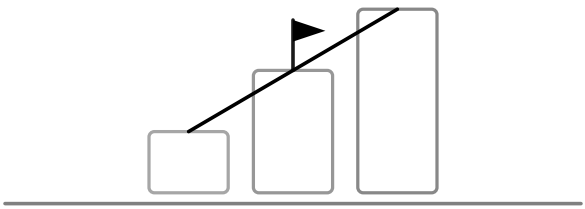
PROVENANCE

Steps written for this deck from the method's public definition; the source has no protocol.

Source: Henri Lipmanowicz & Keith McCandless (2014). *The Surprising Power of Liberating Structures.*

SMART Action Roadmap

Time-phased mapping of milestones adhering to SMART validation criteria



AT A GLANCE

3–12 people · 30–45 min · beginner

WS-45

SMART Action Roadmap

RUN IT

1. Lay the goal out as milestones in order, each a result the team can see rather than a phase.
2. Test every milestone against specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound, then rewrite.
3. Calendar each milestone and name its first step.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Milestones that pass the acronym but not the calendar: none has an owner, a date, or a number.

THE FIX

Take the weakest one and ask for the date, number, and person; without all three, it is a wish.

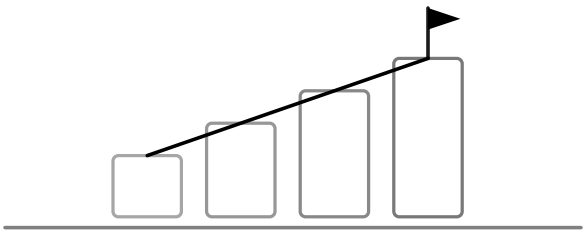
PROVENANCE

Steps written for this deck from the method's public definition; the source has no protocol.

Source: George T. Doran (1981). *There's a S.M.A.R.T. way to write management's goals and objectives.* Management Review.

RACI Alignment Mapping

Structural assignment of Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, and Informed



AT A GLANCE

4–12 people · 45–60 min · intermediate

WS-46

RACI Alignment Mapping

RUN IT

1. List the decisions or deliverables that each need one clear owner before work starts.
2. For each row, name who is responsible for the work and exactly one person accountable for it.
3. Check overload, then confirm each person accepts.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Two accountable names in a row, or a name in every column, so the map looks full while decisions stall.

THE FIX

Put one accountable name in every row, and remove anyone marked both who does not do the work.

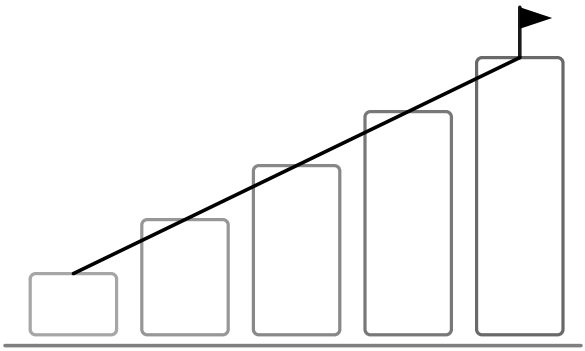
PROVENANCE

Steps written for this deck from the method's public definition; the source has no protocol.

A responsibility charting convention used across project management; no single documented originator.

Assumption Test Card

Scientific decomposition of hypotheses into verification tests and success thresholds



AT A GLANCE

2–10 people · 30–40 min · intermediate

WS-47

Assumption Test Card

RUN IT

1. Pick the assumption the plan depends on most and would hurt most if it turned out wrong.
2. Rewrite it as a measurable, falsifiable hypothesis.
3. Set the success threshold first, then design the smallest test that could contradict it.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

A test that can only confirm: leading questions and counted enthusiasm let the assumption survive.

THE FIX

Ask what result would prove the assumption wrong, then design the test so that result could actually appear.

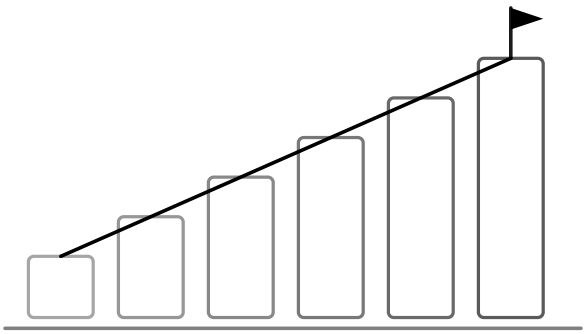
PROVENANCE

Steps written for this deck from the method's public definition; the source has no protocol.

A common lean experimentation practice; no single documented originator.

Definition of Done Workshop

Technical consensus alignment on quality gates for release readiness



AT A GLANCE

3–15 people · 40–60 min · advanced

WS-48

Definition of Done Workshop

RUN IT

1. Name the increment the criteria cover, then list what must be true before it is finished.
2. Turn vague items into pass-or-fail checks, tested against a recent release and its defects.
3. Publish the checks and name who may change them.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Activity criteria: the list records work done, such as code reviewed, but not what must be true for done.

THE FIX

Take each item and ask how a reviewer verifies it in five minutes; if no one can, rewrite it as a check.

PROVENANCE

Steps written for this deck from the method's public definition; the source has no protocol.

A shared team standard from Scrum practice; no single documented originator.